Tough conversations playbook

How Kishan handles difficult messages from parents, with replies ready to adapt. Use it with the **reply-as-me** skill.

The pattern for every tough message: thank → acknowledge (in their words) → facts → plan + time → offer a call.

- Never argue in text. If it's heated, send a calm holding reply and **call**.
- Never mention another child's marks, fees or behaviour.
- Never promise discounts, refunds, marks or schedule changes Kishan hasn't decided. Where a decision is needed, there are two versions: **If yes** and **If no**.
- `[Policy: …]` means Kishan has to fill it in once (and save it to `me/academy.md`).

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1. "My child scored so low. What are you teaching?"

```
Hi! Thank you for telling me. I completely understand your concern 🙏
I went through [Name]'s paper: most marks were lost in [area, e.g.
numericals / long answers]. [He/She] understands the concepts in
class, so this is fixable.
Here's the plan: [extra practice sheet + re-test on date]. I'll update
you after the re-test.
Can I call you this evening for 5 minutes?
```

Notes: lead with the specific cause, not a defence. Fill `[area]` only from the marked paper or the test-results analysis.

2. Request for a fee discount or instalments

If yes:

```
Hi! Thank you for being open with me 🙏 Yes, we can do that.
[Arrangement: e.g. ₹[amount] on [date] and ₹[amount] on [date].]
I'll note it on my side. Please don't worry, and let's keep [Name]'s
studies going as usual.
```

If no:

```
Hi! I understand, and thank you for telling me 🙏 I'm not able to
change the fee itself, but I can [alternative: give a little more time
/ split it into two parts]. Would that help?
```

Notes: decide case by case. Once it's agreed, the fee messages for that family use the arrangement wording (see `parent-fee-messages`).

3. "We'll pay the fees a bit late this month"

```
Hi! No problem at all, thanks for letting me know 🙂 Please pay
whenever you can by [date].
```

Notes: if no date was given, write "whenever it's convenient this month". Don't send reminders before that date.

4. Request to change batch timing

If a seat is available:

```
Hi! Sure 🙂 [Name] can join the [time] batch from [day, date]. I'll
add [him/her] to that group.
```

If not:

```
Hi! I checked. The [time] batch is full right now 🙏 I'll keep [Name]
first on the list and tell you as soon as a seat opens. Till then, the
current batch continues as usual.
```

5. "My child says they don't understand the teaching"

```
Hi! Thank you for telling me. This is exactly the kind of thing I want
to know 🙏
I'll sit with [Name] for a few minutes after class on [day] to see
where exactly it's getting difficult. Sometimes it's one missing
concept from earlier classes.
I'll update you after that. Please ask [him/her] to note down any
doubts too.
```

If the complaint is about another teacher: thank them, say you'll look into it personally, and **call**. Don't discuss the teacher in text.

6. "Another coaching class / another student got more marks"

```
Hi! I understand you want the best for [Name], and so do I 🙂
Rather than comparing, let's look at [his/her] own progress: [first
test marks] → [latest marks]. [Specific improvement or gap.]
The next goal is [specific, e.g. full marks in Section A]. I'll keep
you updated.
```

Notes: never discuss another child's marks, even if the parent names them.

7. Raising a behaviour issue (Kishan starts the conversation)

```
Hi! Hope you're doing well 🙂 I wanted to share something small before
it becomes a habit.
[Name] has been [specific behaviour, e.g. using the phone during
class] for the last [few classes].
[He/She] is a bright student, so I'd really like [him/her] to make the
most of the class. Could you have a gentle word at home? I'll keep an
eye on it too.
```

Notes: one specific behaviour, no labels ("careless", "naughty"). Start and end with something positive.

8. "We want to stop classes" (mid-year withdrawal)

```
Hi! Thank you for letting me know 🙏 May I ask what made you decide?
It really helps me improve.
[Policy: fees for the current [month/quarter] are … / refund rule …]
If there's anything I can change (timing, extra help), please do tell
me. Either way, I wish [Name] all the best!
```

Notes: ask the reason once, gently, and never pressure. Refund wording follows the policy. If there is no policy yet, send the holding reply and decide.

9. Asking for extra classes free of cost

If yes:

```
Hi! Sure 🙂 [Name] can join the doubt-solving session on [day] at
[time].
```

If no:

```
Hi! I understand 🙏 The extra sessions are [Policy: part of the
special batch / paid at ₹…]. What I can do is [alternative: give
[him/her] practice sheets / answer doubts after class on [day]].
```

10. Messages late at night

Reply the next morning:

```
Good morning! Sorry, I saw your message only now 🙂 [Answer.]
```

Optional one-time group note (beginning of the year):

```
Hello Parents, a small request: I reply to messages between [9 AM] and
[8 PM]. For anything urgent, please call. Thank you for
understanding 🙏
```

11. Child absent for many days without informing

```
Hi! Hope everything is okay at home 🙏 [Name] hasn't been in class
since [date], so I just wanted to check in.
We've covered [topics] meanwhile. I'll share the notes so [he/she] can
catch up.
Do let me know if there's anything I should be aware of.
```

12. A negative public review (Google / social media)

A public reply should be short and calm, and move the conversation private. Never share student details.

```
Thank you for your feedback. I'm sorry to hear about your experience,
and I'd really like to understand and fix it. Please call or message
me at [number] so we can talk. — Kishan, Level Up Academy
```

Then call the parent. Never argue in public, and never reveal marks, fees or attendance.

13. "What marks did [another child] get?"

Hi! I'm sorry, I share each child's marks only with their own parents 🙂 I hope you understand. But I'm happy to talk about how [Name] is doing compared with [his/her] last test!

14. "My child is very stressed about exams"

Hi! Thank you for telling me. This is really important 🙏
A little nervousness is normal, but let's not let it become too much. From my side, I'll [give a clear revision plan / keep tests low-pressure / talk to [him/her] after class].
At home, sleep, light food and some fun time help more than extra hours of studying. And please do tell [him/her] that marks are not everything 🙂
Can we talk on the phone tomorrow?

If there is any sign of serious distress, call the parent the same day. Don't handle it only over text.

15. "Please re-check my child's paper / marks"

Hi! Of course 🙂 Please send me a photo of the page, and I'll re-check it today.

After re-checking:

- *If there was a mistake:* Hi! You're right, I missed [x] mark(s) in Q[n]. Updated score: [marks]/[max]. Sorry about that 🙏
- *If the marks are correct:* Hi! I re-checked it. In Q[n], the answer needed [missing point], which is why [x] mark(s) were cut. I'll show [Name] how to write it for full marks next time 🙂

16. "But I already paid!" (disputed fee)

Hi! Thank you, let me check my records right away 🙏 Could you share the date and mode of payment (cash / UPI) and a screenshot if you have one?

Then check the fee tracker. Never argue an amount from memory. If it was Kishan's error, apologise and confirm in writing.